

Belkin brings you Skype

Belkin announces their new Wi-Fi Skype phones



Blackberry Storm 2

Blackberry Storm 2 is expected to support Wi-Fi

Blackberry Curve 8520

Finally affordable

RIM, the company behind Blackberry phones plan to do away with the whole phone for the businessman image. Their new Blackberry Curve 8520 is a much cheaper phone at just Rs. 15,990 but what do you not get as compared to the costlier models?

Firstly, there isn't the sandy-feel scroll ball. It's replaced by a slightly tacky but effective trackpad which doubles as a button. It makes usage a little more easier and effortless. There are a few glitches while using in bright daylight though. The QWERTY keypad still has the slightly banked and chopped design to it. Even though the keys seem tiny, using your fingers isn't a problem with this kind of design. The back

of the phone is a little squishy and you can feel the quality when you punch in keys which isn't so nice.

The sides of the body have a layer of rubber and this covers the controls available on the sides for the volume level, the camera and voice command buttons. This phone was meant to be for the every day Joe, so for ease, dedicated multimedia buttons are present on the body. The voice quality was average.

The interface is still fast and all the usual software bundle is still present. The battery is a 1150mAh one and we didn't face any instances of the phone running out of juice.

Some of the other options in this price range are the cheaper Nokia E63 and the sturdier E71. All in all, it's a good phone

for Rs. 15,990. It's currently available through Airtel.



Contact

Airtel / RIM

Phone: SMS 543210 (Airtel) for information

Price: Rs. 15,990

Web-site: www.blackberry.com

Specifications

Screen: 2.46-inch, 320x240;

Camera: 2.0 MP;

Connectivity: WiFi b/g and Bluetooth;

Battery: 1150mAh;

Dimensions: 109 x 60 x 13.9 mm;

Weight: 106 g

RATINGS

Features	7.5
Performance	7
Build quality	6.5
Value for money	7
Overall	7

Western Digital My Book World II

A cool looking external storage solution with features to boot

Contact

Western Digital Corporation

Phone: +91-93210 29204

Email: amarjeet.singh@wdc.com

Web site: wdc.com

Price: Rs. 24,000

Specifications

Capacity: 2 TB RAID 0/1,

Connectivity: 10/100/1000

Mbps Ethernet, USB (expansion)

Dimensions: 166 x 160 x 99 mm

Weight: 2.5 kg

RATINGS

Features	8
Performance	7
Build Quality	6
Value for Money	6
Overall	7

Western Digital's My Book World Edition II series is a networked

external storage device that tries to make all your data centrally accessible and safe too. It sports a cool vanilla-colored casing that bears two 1TB WD hard disks packed side-by-side. The casing is probably not the toughest when it comes to external desktop drives. On the positive side, the hard disks are easily swappable. It connects to a router via the Ethernet port. Along with the Ethernet port, a USB port is provided for expansion, as well as making any USB-based memory device accessible to the network. While the network connectivity is a great thing to have, it is

somewhat disappointing that the drive can't be directly connected to a PC via USB.

The Dual hard-disks support RAID 0 (Mirroring) and RAID 1 (Stripe) that makes the two hard-drives behave like one large 2TB drive. It includes automatic backup software and a service that lets you access the drive from the internet. It can also be used as a media and iTunes server. All the settings can be tweaked using an easy-to-use web interface; although we wish it was not as laggy. With respect to performance, we can say that it is on par with other network drives. The performance is almost a third of an USB external drive.

For roughly Rs. 25,000,

the drive is somewhat expensive. It would make sense to buy this only if you are looking for a NAS solution that has some of the unique features mentioned above. .

